Environmental Pollution Control was adopted in 1967 in Japan, which was concerned about the food poisoning caused by consumption of fish with traces of mercury discharged by the gold mining process. India passed the Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act in 1974 and the Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act in 1981.

The Stockholm Conference, the first international conference on environmental issues, was convened in 1972. It spurred global consciousness on the consequences of the development and industrialization model and the need to take corrective steps. The UN Environment Programme (UNEP) was launched in 1972, around the same time.

The world has come a long way since. In 1992, the Earth Summit drew up a major agenda and set of agreements to protect the environment. The last major milestone was the Paris Agreement in 2015. There have also been numerous conventions on different chemicals and materials causing pollution and global warming.

Use of Fuels and Chemicals in Production and Distribution of Goods and Services Is at the Root of Environmental Crisis

The use of fossil fuels—oil, coal and natural gas—and materials, especially chemicals, as sources of energy and inputs, creates almost all the impacts, whether personal, local or global.

Formation of CO_2 takes place from the use of fossil fuels in myriad processes of production and distribution (in agriculture, industries and transportation). CO_2 is the largest factor/agent that impacts the global climate. CO_2 and a few other gases, when released in the environment, act as GHGs.

Other gases can be equated in terms of CO_2. The totality of CO_2 equivalent gases has been growing massively since industrialization spread